



MCiE1012

Moral and Civic Education

COLLEGE OF SOCIAL SCIENCES AND HUMANITIES
Department of Social Sciences

Course Outline

2nd Semester 2026/27

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1 Course Information

Course Code	MCiE1012
Course Name	Moral and Civic Education
Year/Semester	Freshman / II
Academic Year	2026/27
Pre-requisite(s)	None
Co-requisite(s)	None
Credit Hour / ECTS	2
Course schedule	To Be Determined (TBD)

2 Instructor Information

2.1 Course Coordinator / Instructor

Name	Mohammed Z.
E-mail	mohammed.zeinu@aastu.edu.et
Telephone number	See Telegram
Consultation hour	Monday, Tuesday, and Thursday (Afternoon)
Office (Block/Room)	Block 80, Room 05
Telegram	t.me/zeinulabid

2.2 Communications

Official channels for this course are Canvas messaging, telegram and in-class announcements. It is your responsibility to regularly check these channels. Missing class or overlooking announcements does not absolve you of accountability. Any email you send to the instructor should be formal and professional.

3 Course Overview

Moral and Civic Education is a course that aims to equip students with a foundation in the principles and applications of civics and ethics. Throughout the course, students explore the definitions of civics, ethics, morality, and amorality, as well as the historical development of civics and ethical education. They delve into the purpose and significance of civics and ethical education, citizens' rights and responsibilities, and the competencies of a good citizen. The course covers various ethical approaches, including teleological ethics such as hedonism, ethical and psychological egoism, and utilitarianism, as well as deontological ethics like the performance of one's own duty, divine-based morality, Kant's categorical imperative, and W.D. Ross's prima facie duty. Students also examine virtue ethics, civic virtues, and non-normative ethics, including meta-ethics. Applied ethics is discussed in areas such as development ethics, environmental ethics, and professional ethics. The concepts of the state, government, and citizenship are explored, encompassing the attributes and structures of the state, types of government, and the nature of citizenship. By the end of the course, students gain an understanding of civics, ethics, and their practical applications, enabling them to develop critical thinking skills, ethical reasoning abilities, and a sense of civic responsibility essential for active participation in society.

4 Course Objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, students will have achieved the following learning outcomes:

- Understand the origin and development of civics and ethical education.
- Recognize the purpose and significance of civics and ethical education in society.
- Identify and discuss the rights and responsibilities of citizens.
- Explore different ethical approaches, including teleological and deontological ethics.
- Analyze and apply ethical theories to real-world situations.
- Examine applied ethics in areas such as development, environmental ethics, and professional ethics.
- Evaluate ethical decision-making processes and moral judgments.
- Understand the attributes and structures of the state and different forms of government.
- Define citizenship, including ways of acquiring and losing citizenship, and its historical context in Ethiopia.
- Explore state formation and nation-building in the Ethiopian context.
- Comprehend the features and purposes of constitutions.
- Discuss different forms of democracy and its fundamental values and principles.
- Analyze the democratization process and the role of major actors.
- Understand the nature of human rights, their protection, and oversight mechanisms.

5 Course Learning Outcomes (CLO)

Upon successful completion of this course, students should be able to:

CLO 1	Understand fundamental concepts of civics, ethics, state, and citizenship.
CLO 2	Analyze various ethical theories and their application to modern dilemmas.
CLO 3	Evaluate the structure and function of government, democracy, and human rights frameworks.
CLO 4	Apply principles of ethical decision-making and civic responsibility to personal and professional life.

Graduate Attributes (PLO)

PLO1 Engineering Knowledge	PLO7 Environment and sustainability
PLO2 Problem Analysis	PLO8 Ethics
PLO3 Design/development of solutions	PLO9 Individual and teamwork
PLO4 Investigation	PLO10 Communication
PLO5 Modern tool usage	PLO11 Project management and finance
PLO6 The engineer and society	PLO12 Lifelong learning

6 Course Schedule and Instructional Method

This course consists of 2 contact hours per week. The modes of delivery include lectures, self-reading, group discussions, case studies, and presentations. Students are expected to take an active role in their learning process through independent research, participation, and assigned tasks.

Week	Topic [Module]	Learning and Teaching Activity	CLO
Week 1-2	Ch 1: Understanding Civics and Ethics Definitions, Origin, Purpose, Rights & Responsibilities, Competencies of a good citizen.	Lecture, Class Discussion, Self-Reading	CLO 1
Week 3-5	Ch 2: Approaches to Ethics Normative Ethics (Teleological, Deontological, Virtue), Non-Normative Ethics, Applied Ethics (Development, Environment, Professional).	Lecture, Group Discussion, Case Studies	CLO 2, 4
Week 6	Ch 3: Ethical Decision Making and Moral Judgments Principles and values, conflicting goals, justifications, and rationale for ethical action.	Lecture, Ethical decision-making exercises	CLO 2, 4
Week 7	Mid-Term Examination	Mid-Exam	CLO 1,2
Week 8-10	Ch 4: State, Government, and Citizenship Attributes of State, Functions of Government, Types/Systems of Government, Citizenship (Acquisition, Loss, Ethiopian Context).	Lecture, Research Assignment, Group Presentation	CLO 1, 3
Week 11-13	Ch 5: Constitution, Democracy and Human Rights Constitutions, Democracy (Forms, Values, Democratization), Human Rights (Nature, Dimensions, Protection, Instruments).	Lecture, Online Discussion Forum, Student Presentations	CLO 3, 4

Week	Topic [Module]	Learning and Teaching Activity	CLO
Week 14	Course Review & Final Exam Preparation	Q&A Session, Review of key concepts	All

7 Assessment Tasks

No	Assessment Method	Weight	Week Due	CLO Assessed
1	Online Tests	15%	TBD	CLO 1, 2, 3
2	Group Assignment (Paper) & Presentation	10%	TBD	CLO 4
3	Mid-Exam	20%	Week 7	CLO 1, 2
4	Attendance and Participation	5%	Ongoing	-
5	Final Exam	50%	Exam Week	All

7.1 Submission of Assessment Tasks

To ensure the efficient operation of this course and fairness to all students, adhering to deadlines is essential. Late submissions will not be accepted. Three-fourths of the next submission will be considered if the student can come up with reasonable and tangible evidence for failing to submit the previous one. Effective time management is crucial for your success.

Assignment Format: All assignments, unless specified otherwise, must be typed (using MS Word or Google Docs) and submitted as a single PDF file via Canvas. It is essential to proofread your work for clarity, grammar, and spelling before submission.

7.2 Feedback on Assessments

Feedback on assignments and tests will be provided to students in a timely manner to support their learning and improvement throughout the course. This will typically occur through online feedback on Canvas, in-class general comments, or during consultation hours.

8 Learning Resources

8.1 Textbook

THE MODULE

8.2 References

- [1.] Frankena, W. (1963). *Ethics*. Prentice-Hall.
- [2.] Almond, G., & Verba, S. (1963). *The Civic Culture*. Princeton University Press.
- [3.] Kymlicka, W., & Norman, W. (1994). Return of the Citizen. *Ethics*, 104(2), 352381.
- [4.] Marshall, T. H. (1977). *Class, Citizenship and Social Development*. Chicago University Press.
- [5.] Rawls, J. (1971). *A Theory of Justice*. Harvard University Press.
- [6.] MacIntyre, A. (1981). *After Virtue: A Study in Moral Theory*. University of Notre Dame Press.
- [7.] Sandel, M. J. (2009). *Justice: Whats the Right Thing to Do?*. Farrar, Straus and Giroux.
- [8.] Habermas, J. (1996). *Between Facts and Norms: Contributions to a Discourse Theory of Law and Democracy*. MIT Press.
- [9.] Baynes, K. (2002). *The Normative Grounds of Social Criticism: Kant, Rawls, and Habermas*. SUNY Press.

8.3 Online Resources

- [1.] United Nations: Universal Declaration of Human Rights
<https://www.un.org/en/about-us/universal-declaration-of-human-rights>
- [2.] Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy: Virtue Ethics
<https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/ethics-virtue/>
- [3.] African Union: African Charter on Human and Peoples Rights
<https://au.int/en/treaties/african-charter-human-and-peoples-rights>
- [4.] Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia Constitution (1995)
https://www.constituteproject.org/constitution/Ethiopia_1994
- [5.] Ethiopian Nationality Proclamation No. 378/2003
<https://www.refworld.org/docid/405da37e4.html>

9 Grading Policy

Grading of courses will be according to the university's rules and regulation. Examinations are graded and the letter grading system with corresponding points shown below.

Marks	Grade	Grade Points
[90,100]	A+	4.00
[85,90)	A	4.00
[80,85)	A-	3.75
[75,80)	B+	3.50
[70,75)	B	3.00
[65,70)	B-	2.75
[60,65)	C+	2.50
[50,60)	C	2.00
<50	F	0.00

9.1 Pass requirements

To pass this course a student must:

- attempt all assessments.
- achieve a minimum of 40% in the final exam.

10 Attendance

Attendance in every class is expected. Not attending class will be detrimental to your progress. The marking for attendance and participation is based on the following criteria:

- **5/5:** Arrives on time and actively participates.
- **4/5:** Arrives on time but does not participate fully.
- **3/5:** Arrives late but actively participates, OR provides a valid excuse for absence.
- **2/5:** Arrives late and does not participate fully.
- **0/5:** Absent without a valid excuse.

10.1 Discussion and Participations

Your active participation in class discussions is crucial for fostering a vibrant learning environment. This classroom strives to create a safe and supportive space where everyone feels comfortable asking questions. There are no "stupid questions." Open communication and a relaxed atmosphere are essential for optimal learning.

11 Academic Integrity, Referencing and Plagiarism

11.1 Academic Integrity

Maintaining academic integrity is paramount in this course and aligns with the AASTU Senate Legislation of 2017. All submitted work, including tests and assignments, must be your own. Referencing resources is encouraged, but proper citation is essential to acknowledge external sources. Copying any portion of external material and presenting it as your own constitutes plagiarism and is strictly prohibited. Violations of academic integrity will be taken seriously and may result in severe consequences, including failing grades and potential dismissal from the course. Remember: Allowing someone to copy your work is as dishonest as copying from someone else.

11.2 Referencing Style

Students are required to use **APA Style (7th Edition)** for all citations and references in written work and presentations. Other styles may be permitted only with prior instructor approval.

11.3 Plagiarism Detection Tools

The university may use AI-detection and similarity-checking systems, like Turnitin, to evaluate student submissions for originality and possible AI-generated content.

11.4 Thresholds for Similarity Index and AI Plagiarism Check

For any documents submitted for final evaluation, the following thresholds guide interpretation:

- a) **0 - 20%:** Generally acceptable; may include references, common phrases, or properly cited material.
- b) **21 - 30%:** Potential concern; may indicate over-reliance on sources or possible misconduct. Requires instructor review.
- c) **>30%:** Not acceptable. The submission is disqualified and will receive a zero mark.
- d) Similarity from a single source should be less than **5%**.

11.5 AI usage

In this course, we view generative AI as a powerful tool that, like a search engine, can be used responsibly or irresponsibly. You are permitted to use AI tools to assist with your work. However, you must adhere to two core principles: **Accountability** and **Transparency**.

Accountability: You are 100% responsible for the work you submit. AI tools can produce inaccurate information, biased arguments, and nonsensical "hallucinations." It is your job to fact-check, edit, and critically evaluate any output you use. Submitting factually incorrect or poorly reasoned work is your failure, not the AI's. The final submission must reflect your own understanding and mastery of the material.

Transparency: You must cite any use of generative AI. At the end of any assignment where you used an AI tool, you must include an "AI Usage Statement" that clearly describes:

- Which AI tool(s) you used (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini, deepseek etc).

- How you used it (e.g., "for brainstorming outlines," "to rephrase sentences I wrote for clarity").
- Key prompts you used if the AI's contribution was significant.

Failure to include a complete and honest AI Usage Statement when AI has been used will be considered a violation of the Academic Honesty policy. Submitting AI-generated work as your own without this disclosure is plagiarism and will result in a serious consequence.

12 Safety and Securities

Report all emergencies or suspicious activity to the office of the Social Science Department:

- **Location:** Block-80, Office number-117
- **Email:** [social sciences department](#)
- **Website:** Department of Social sciences -[Website](#)